

Europe Healthcare: Medical Technology: Further share gains for Oticon Zeal underline real momentum; reiterate Buy on Demant

Hearing Aid data from the VA (U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs) for June, released at the end of last week, highlighted several key points. **(1)** Overall sales and unit growth accelerated in June to +5% and +13%, respectively, providing a strong end to Q2. **(2)** Oticon delivered further share gains with an additional +70bps of sequential value share gains, now +420bps of share gains vs April (prior to the launch of Zeal). **(3)** Supported by key launches in the ITE category, the Custom Hearing Aid Category now represents ~22% of Hearing Aids total value in the VA (up from ~15% in June 2025); we believe that a step change in technological capabilities in the latest generation ITE products from Demant and Sonova, combined with discreet form factor, has potential to expand the addressable market for hearing aids.

We review performance of the European listed manufacturers below; note total value includes Hearings Aids and chargers...

Oticon (Demant, Buy) saw Y/Y unit and value growth of +27.2% and +55.4% in June. In terms of market share, Oticon's value market share has increased from 18.9% in April (prior to Zeal launch) to 23.1% in June. We note that +420bps share gain in two months post launch compares favourably to other recent launches. Specifically Oticon Intent drove +210bps share gains for Oticon between April 2024-June 2024; Infinio Sphere drove +70bps share gain for Phonak between April 2025-June 2025; Vivia drove +60bps for Resound between April 2025-June 2025. We estimate that the VA channel alone will contribute +240bps of Hearing Aid organic growth for Demant in Q2 26.

Phonak (Sonova, Neutral) achieved Y/Y unit and value growth of +19.0% and +22.2% in June. In terms of market share, Phonak's unit share decreased from 51.2% in May to 50.8% in June, while its value share (including chargers) decreased from 51.9% to 51.2% during the same period; we note substantial share losses in the Custom Hearing Aid Category post the launch of Zeal.

GN Resound (GN Store Nord, Not Rated) saw Y/Y unit decline of -8.6% in June, although value growth by +11.7% on Y/Y basis. In terms of market share, Resound's unit share increased from 9.1% in May to 9.3% in June, while its value share (including chargers) increased from 9.4% to 9.7% during the same period.

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Summary charts

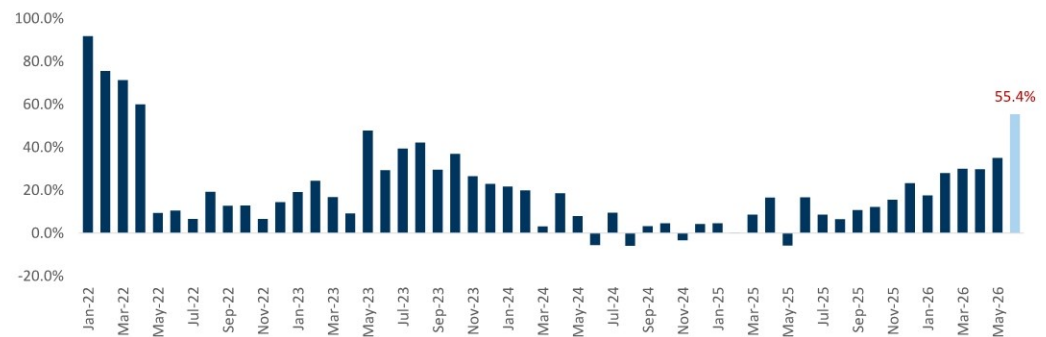
Exhibit 1: Hearing aids: Summary snapshot for June 2026 (hearing aids only for units; hearing aids + chargers for sales growth)

Period	Market share		(YoY) Unit growth in latest...				(YoY) Sales growth in latest...			
	Units	Value	Month	Comp	3 months	12 months	Month	Comp	3 months	12 months
Jun-26										
Total Industry			5.0%	7.8%	-0.5%	1.0%	13.8%	32.7%	13.5%	24.5%
Oticon	22.8%	23.1%	27.2%	0.8%	12.4%	-0.6%	55.4%	16.6%	39.9%	23.0%
Sonova/Phonak	50.8%	51.2%	19.0%	1.6%	13.4%	8.9%	22.2%	30.1%	24.4%	33.5%
GN Resound	9.3%	9.7%	-8.6%	6.8%	-10.4%	1.4%	11.7%	19.0%	12.8%	31.9%
Starkey	10.2%	9.4%	-31.1%	16.5%	-35.3%	-18.9%	-29.7%	43.5%	-29.8%	-3.8%

Source: Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Veterans affairs

Exhibit 2: Oticon saw strong y/y value growth

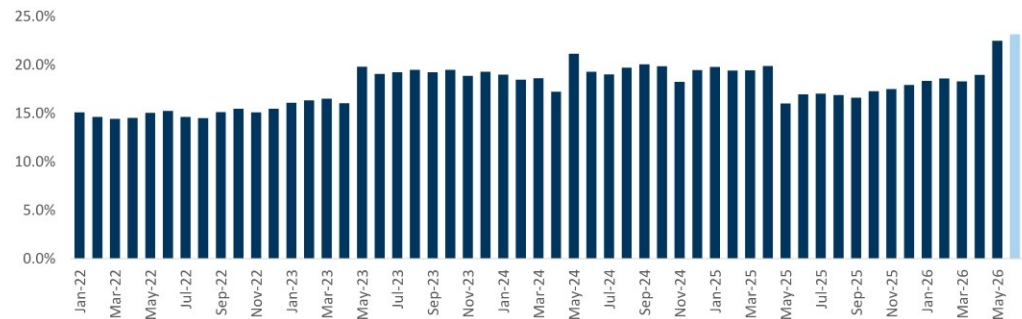
Oticon y/y value growth in the VA channel



Source: Veterans Affairs

Exhibit 3: ...and reached all-time highs in VA value share in June 2026 (2nd month since its the launch in the VA channel in May)

Oticon - Value market share



Source: Veterans Affairs

Valuation and risks

Demant

Valuation methodology: Our 12m price target of DKK 290 is derived using an equal blend of a DCF and a multiples-based valuation (using our annualised Q5-Q8 estimates). Our DCF implies an intrinsic value of DKK 287 per share and uses a WACC of 8% and terminal growth of +2.5%. Our multiples-based approach applies a 17.0x P/E multiple to

our annualised Q5-Q8 EPS estimates and implies a value of DKK 292 per share. We are Buy rated.

Key downside risks. Slower market growth, failure to gain share in the independent channel, competitor product launches, share gains for Apple AirPods and Nuance Audio.

Sonova

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month price target is CHF 230. Our valuation is derived from a blended DCF and multiple approach, each carrying a 50% weighting. Our DCF implies an intrinsic value of CHF 238 per share and uses a WACC of 7.9% and terminal growth of +2.5%. Our multiples-based approach applies a 19x P/E multiple to our annualised Q5-Q8 EPS estimates and implies a value of CHF 223 per share. We are Neutral rated.

Key risks: Downside risks to our view and price target include: (1) Execution risk in Phonak Infinio products, (2) Near-term hearing aid category headwinds persisting, (3) Share gains for Apple AirPods. Key upside risks include: (1) Infinio Sphere performs better than anticipated, (2) Operating leverage flows through better than anticipated, (3) Further share gains in Costco.

GN Store Nord - Not Rated

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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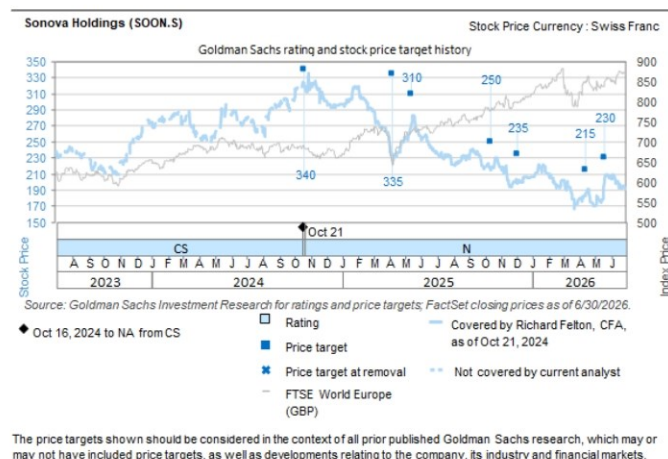
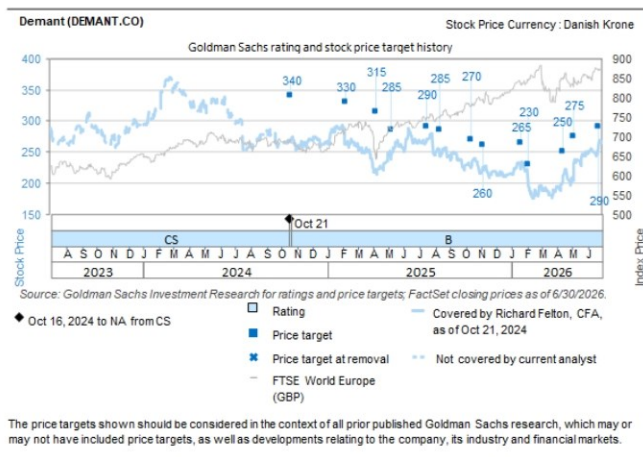
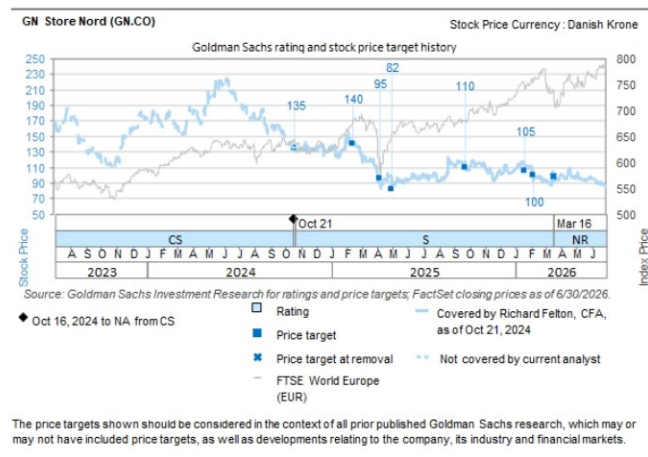
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Demant (DEMANT.CO)

Date of report	Target price (Dkr)	Closing price (Dkr)
24-Jun-26	290.00	261.40
06-May-26	275.00	232.00
13-Apr-26	250.00	202.80
05-Feb-26	230.00	192.30
20-Jan-26	265.00	224.40
05-Nov-25	260.00	226.00
13-Oct-25	270.00	224.00
13-Aug-25	285.00	243.00
18-Jul-25	290.00	272.00
07-May-25	285.00	237.40
08-Apr-25	315.00	222.80
07-Feb-25	330.00	265.00
21-Oct-24	340.00	267.40

Sonova Holdings (SOON.S)

Date of report	Target price (SFr)	Closing price (SFr)
20-May-26	230.00	203.00
13-Apr-26	215.00	183.30
04-Dec-25	235.00	200.20
13-Oct-25	250.00	218.30
14-May-25	310.00	272.30
08-Apr-25	335.00	233.80
21-Oct-24	340.00	320.60

GN Store Nord (GN.CO)

Date of report	Target price (Dkr)	Closing price (Dkr)
06-Feb-26	100.00	98.86

Date of report	Target price (Dkr)	Closing price (Dkr)
20-Jan-26	105.00	112.05
23-Sep-25	110.00	117.90
01-May-25	82.00	86.76
08-Apr-25	95.00	90.66
12-Feb-25	140.00	141.35
21-Oct-24	135.00	134.80

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